Committee: United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC)

Topic: The Question of Eradicating Illegal Organ Trafficking Networks in the Black Market

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Introduction

Illegal organ trafficking is a persistent and severe challenge to human rights, bioethics, and law enforcement that the current global society faces. Since the late 20th century, the success of human organ transplantation surgeries and the medical development of organ transplantation have offered life-saving opportunities to numerous patients around the world, while triggering ethical and institutional dilemmas globally. Behind these medical breakthroughs, human bodies have increasingly been reduced to commercial commodities, fostering a global black market where socially vulnerable populations are systematically exploited.

At the core of this crisis lies a severe and structural mismatch between medical demand and legal supply. Globally, patients who are waiting for organ transplants have increased explosively while legal organ supplies based on voluntary donations remain insufficient. The huge gaps combine with economic inequality, providing a foundation where illicit organ trafficking networks can flourish.

The difficulty in eradicating illicit organ trafficking is that crime happens across countries and their response systems are not connected to each other. While illegal trade subtly crosses the borders of states, the legal regulations and law enforcement power remain bound within national borders. Although the international community seeks measures through various treaties and declarations, gaps in national legislation and limits of cooperation allow illicit networks to evade the law. Moreover, rapid technological developments strengthen anonymity and complexity that makes it difficult for the international community to respond. Consequently, to solve this problem, a comprehensive approach is needed, rather than temporary enforcement.

To establish a sustainable solution, the international community should solve the structural problem that triggers illicit organ trafficking black markets. In particular, they should dismantle transnational illegal networks through transparent information sharing. Moreover, ethical donor self-sufficiency leads citizens to make voluntary choices with strong transparency. Therefore, countries must ensure that attempts to expand organ donations are not distorted into legal or structural coercion.

Definition of Key Terms

Black Market

The black market, or the underground black market, is a place where goods or services are illegally trafficked, for example, drugs, weapons, endangered plants or animals, to bypass regulations, taxes, or price controls of the governments. The purpose of this is to avoid high tariffs or to trade without filing an income tax return, which enables sellers to maximize profits. Moreover, if specific goods or services lack supply or the governments regulate to lower the price, it can be traded at a higher value in the black market. However, it greatly affects national finance and customers are vulnerable to scamming and defective products as customer protection policies are not applied. This market is led by illegal networks and brokers, operating only in underground markets evading the law. These individuals connect buyers and sellers, arranging face-to-face meetings through the dark web or encrypted messaging apps such as Telegram. Trafficking in persons for the purpose of organ removal(TIP for OR) often happens as they deceive vulnerable people or kidnap, forcibly confine, and threaten other individuals to forcefully remove organs. They hire doctors whose medical licenses have been revoked and corrupt medical professionals to perform unauthorized surgeries, so both donors and recipients are exposed to the danger of fatal side effects.

TIP for OR (Trafficking in persons for the purpose of organ removal)

Trafficking in persons for the purposes of organ removal(TIP for OR) is a form of trafficking in which an individual is exploited for an organ. The number of patients who need transplantation surgery has increased, but there is a critical shortage of legally donated organs. Thus, desperate individuals increasingly turn to illegal methods, which allows traffickers to engage in illegal organ transplants. These criminal networks target places which have lax regulations and impoverished areas with widespread corruption, deceiving and threatening vulnerable people to remove organs.

Organ Trafficking

Organ trafficking comprises three core elements. First, illicit removal is forcibly removing organs without the donor's consent. Even if consent is given, any transaction involving financial gain renders it a crime. Second, trafficking and transportation is an act of distribution that involves trafficking, transporting, harboring, and gathering extracted illicit organs, both within national borders

and internationally. Last, exploitation and commercialization is to take advantage of the poverty and refugee status of vulnerable populations. As refugees and low-income individuals have weak legal protection, they are forced to keep silent about illegal organ trafficking. Moreover, exploiting their economic hardship, brokers purchase organs from vulnerable individuals at low prices and sell them for a large amount of money, leaving donors with minimal earnings. In this process, corrupt medical professionals intervene to gain profits. According to the World Health Organization(WHO), organ donation must not involve financial compensation or material incentives. Otherwise, it is defined as organ trafficking.

Transplant Tourism

Transplant tourism refers to the travel of patients, donors or organs across international borders for transplantation involving commercial transactions, exploitation of vulnerable populations, or the use of resources outside a country's official health system. In regions with institutional corruption or weak legal enforcement, illicit brokers exploit local residents through illegal organ removal. Under the Declaration of Istanbul, an international bioethical framework established by medical societies, not the UN, it should be proved that donor and recipient formed a close relationship and the transplant must receive transparent approval from the visited nation's official organization and ethics committee. Furthermore, when individuals who undergo an organ transplant in other countries return to their country, they are required to register their official medical records with national health authorities to verify full legal compliance.

Organ Laundering

Organ laundering is when criminal groups falsify medical documents about illegally removed and trafficked organs in the black market, which are disguised as legally donated organs and used in regular medical systems. Similar to money laundering, the source of criminal profits is disguised as legal profits. To get legal admission for the operation from the government to bypass strict regulations, brokers and traffickers forge documents. As organ transplant surgery ensures enormous wealth, corrupt medical professionals collude with organized criminal groups.

Commercial Organ Trade

Commercial organ trade is the act of buying and selling human organs in exchange for financial compensation or material benefits due to a severe imbalance between high global demand

and limited voluntary supply. While often criminalized as illicit trafficking, it also includes government-regulated commercial systems, as seen in Iran. Unlike legal organ donations for humanitarian purposes, it treats human organs as commodities. Furthermore, the exploitation of vulnerable populations, especially in developing regions, by illegal organ trafficking networks brings about severe bioethical concerns. Despite exceptional attempts like Iran's kidney sales system, commercial organ trade globally remains a complicated ethical, legal, and human rights challenge.

Donor Self-Sufficiency

Donor self-sufficiency is a concept where, instead of relying on transplant tourism or importing organs from other countries, each country can independently meet the organ demand of domestic patients through voluntary organ donations and domestic transplantation systems. Rather than focusing merely on expanding organ donations, governments must ensure that citizens give fully informed and voluntary consent, and that transparency is maintained. Thus, this will essentially reduce the imbalance between organ supply and demand, evaluated as a major solution to protect patients' human rights.

Background Information

The Success of Transplant Surgery

Historically, doctors made early attempts to succeed in performing surgeries on animals. In 1838, there was an initial endeavor to transfer the cornea of a pig to the human. However, as scientists did not realize that animals and humans are genetically distinct, the moment animal organs were connected, the human immune system aggressively attacked foreign tissues, which were from transplanted organs of the animals. Eventually, it triggered immune rejection and led to the failure of surgery.

In 1954, the kidney was the first human organ that was transplanted successfully by Doctor Joseph E. Murray, at Peter Bent Brigham Hospital in Boston, carried out between identical twins. In the late 1960s, successful transplantations of the liver, heart, and pancreas were achieved, while procedures for lungs and intestinal organs became successful in the 1980s. However, until the early 1980s, immune rejection of our bodies limited the number of transplantations. Soon, the introduction of cyclosporine, an innovative medication that prevents the body from rejecting transplanted organs, effectively suppressed the immune system of patients, resulting in successful surgeries.

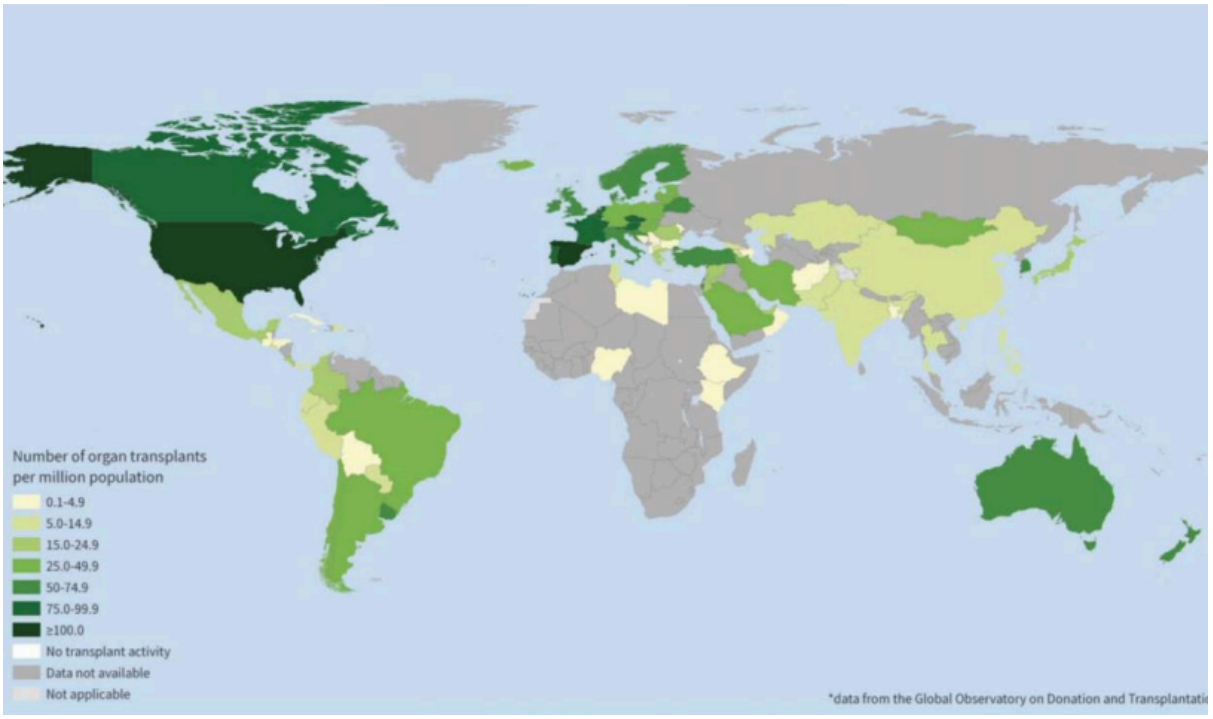
Chronic Supply Shortages and the Emergence of the Black Market

After the introduction of cyclosporine, the demand for organs rapidly increased, but legally donated organs were lacking. Because of an imbalance of supply and demand, broker networks and a black market for transplant tourism emerged, targeting vulnerable groups in developing countries. According to the Global Observatory on Donation and Transplantation(GODT, 2020), although over 150,000 transplants are performed globally each year, this meets less than 10% of the worldwide demand. Consequently, some critically ill patients bypass legal frameworks to get transplant surgery even if it is exploiting susceptible groups.

Current Movement of Illegal Organ Trafficking

Global Financial Integrity(GFI, 2017) estimated that the global illegal organ trade generates conservative annual revenues between USD $840 million to $1.7 billion, which facilitates approximately 12,000 illegal transplants each year, with an estimated 10% of all transplants

worldwide being illegal at the time of the study. With technological advancements, the method of organ trafficking has varied. Organ trafficking operations heavily rely on the anonymity of cryptocurrencies, pervasive social media, as well as laundered money and illicit bank transfer, posing challenges to law enforcement to crack down on these networks. Furthermore, vulnerable populations affected by conflict, climate change, and economic crises are targeted by organ trafficking brokers. Today, organ trafficking is a transnational organized crime that covertly connects illicit brokers, wealthy customers, and corrupt medical institutions. One of the most terrible cases of organ trafficking in the 21st century is known as The Medicus Clinic Scandal in Kosovo. This clinic harvested kidneys from impoverished donors and transplanted them into wealthy recipients from Western countries for high transaction costs. The transplantation surgeries were performed illegally and the case has been revealed to be an international incident involving organ trafficking and organized crime. Then, the police of Kosovo and international law enforcement agencies investigated and indicted related doctors. Later, it led to a conviction.



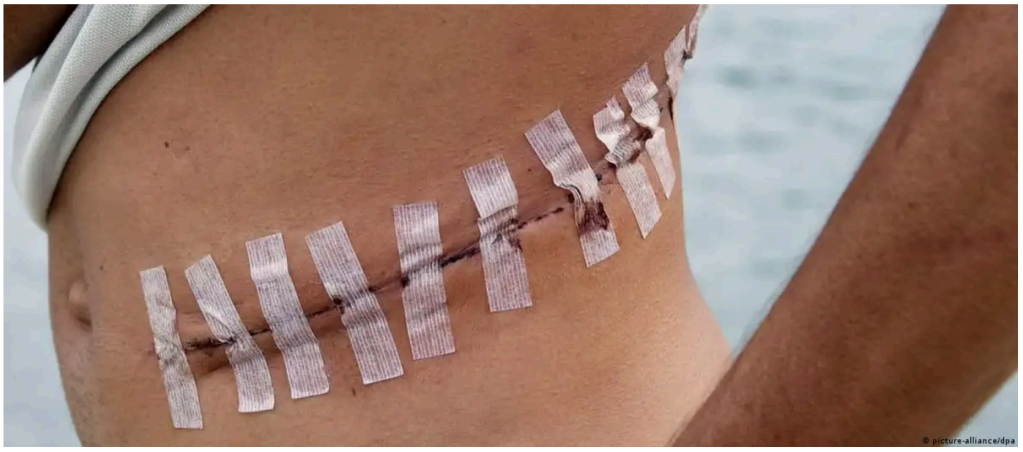
Global transplantation activities of solid organs(Global Observatory on Donation and Transplantation, 2022)

Among various organs, kidneys account for 70% to 80% of the global illicit trade, which is the overwhelming majority. As humans have two kidneys, donors can survive with a single kidney. The liver is the second most commonly trafficked organ after the kidneys. It has advanced regenerative ability so that it enables donating part of a living liver. However, the difficulty of the

surgery is higher than kidneys. Other organs that are traded are cornea, pancreas, and hearts, but they have a lower unit price than kidneys or face extremely narrow time windows for preservation after retrieval.

Challenges that Global Society Faces in Tackling Illegal Organ Trafficking

Organ trafficking is an international problem that severely undermines human rights, public health, and international rule of law. Specifically, black markets thrive by abusing vulnerability, exploiting populations such as refugees and the impoverished, and by commercializing human organs. In this process, brokers pay a pittance to donors and gain large profits from recipients, which will lead donors to extreme poverty and deteriorating health. Moreover, performing transplantation surgeries in unsanitary informal facilities can bring about a high mortality rate and the risk of diseases. Furthermore, organized crime groups combined with document forgery, collusion with medical institutions, and money laundering undermine the fairness of and public trust in legal organ removal systems.



An unidentified man shows the scar after an operation to remove his kidney in Durban, South Africa(alliance/dpa, 2023)

The reason organ trafficking is continually discussed globally is because of the severe imbalance between the global demand for organs and limited legal supply, as well as the existence of legal and technological loopholes that cannot be addressed solely by traditional legal frameworks or a single country's response. For instance, the Palermo Protocol included the provision on organ removal, but legal interpretations vary across countries' laws, making it difficult to prosecute transnational broker networks. Furthermore, the trade fundamentally operates through transplant tourism, where donors, recipients, brokers, and medical professionals reside in different countries.

This limits the law enforcement capacity of single nations, necessitating coordinated international policing. Lastly, modern broker networks actively utilize the dark web, social media platforms, and anonymous cryptocurrency transactions. This compels countries to update international money tracking systems and cybercrime coordination guidelines.

Efforts of International Communities to Tackle Organ Trafficking

Protocol to Prevent, Suppress and Punish Trafficking in Persons, Especially Women and Children, which is called Palermo Protocol, was adopted in Palermo, Italy in 2000 and came into effect in 2003. It is the first agreement that clarifies the removal of organs as one of the major categories of human trafficking and exploitation, which established legal definition. Especially, when brokers recruit, transport, transfer, or harbor victims by abusing the vulnerabilities of victims who suffer from poverty and face refugee status, it strictly regulates criminal offences regardless of consent of victims. Therefore, this protocol mandates strengthening the protection of victims and judicial cooperation between states and criminalizing illegal organ trafficking to state parties.

The Declaration of Istanbul on Organ Trafficking and Transplant Tourism, a non-UN bioethical framework, was enacted in 2008 by more than 150 medical experts and the leadership of The Transplantation Society(TTS) and the International Society of Nephrology(ISN), serving as a definitive ethical framework guiding global organ transplantation by clearly defining and strictly prohibiting organ trafficking, transplant commercialism, transplant tourism, and TIP for OR. The declaration stipulates these practices as violations of human dignity and equity and establishes clear ethical boundaries for healthcare professionals and medical institutions to prevent colluding in illegal organ trafficking or turning a blind eye to illicit organ sourcing. Furthermore, it strongly urges nations to achieve national self-sufficiency in donated organs, so that it can cut reliance on illegal organ trades that exploit vulnerable populations.

From September 29th to October 4th, 2024, Operation Liberterra II was implemented by INTERPOL, carried out across 116 countries and territories. The operation directly addresses severe forms of exploitation, including TIP for OR and migrant smuggling. It led to the rescue of 3,222 potential victims, identified 17,793 irregular migrants, and arrested a total of 2,517 criminals. Through the operation, in Syria, a group of doctors suspected of organ trafficking were successfully identified. Therefore, it demonstrates the necessity of police cooperation and the importance of real-time intelligence sharing.

Operation Liberterra III was led by INTERPOL in cooperation with UNODC in November 2025, mobilizing more than 14,000 officers operating in 119 countries. It especially cracked down on TIP for OR, money laundering, and forced labor. In two weeks, the operation successfully arrested 3,744 suspects and safeguarded 4,414 potential victims of human trafficking. One of the successful cases of this operation is a child from Mozambique who had been kidnapped for organ removal and was safeguarded from human trafficking.

Possible solutions

Although the international community agrees on punishing illegal organ trafficking, there are different legal definitions and the severity of punishment in each country. In this process, the demand of affluent countries and the supply of developing countries are combined, causing persistent exploitation and inequality. While various policies are implemented, national budgetary limits in developing nations remain a constraint. Therefore, possible solutions are needed that cover financial and technical assistance, education, tracking, and deterring demand.

Strengthening Legal Accountability

When individuals travel abroad to undergo illicit transplant surgeries, their home countries are encouraged to consider expanding extraterritorial jurisdiction to enforce legal accountability and impose punitive fines. Additionally, medical professionals and institutions that facilitate or perform these unauthorized transplants should face regulatory measures,including medical license revocation, facility shutdown, or asset freeze, depending on the severity of the crime. Ultimately, all individuals associated with trafficking networks and brokering should face legal liability.

Disrupting the Illegal Organ Supply

Since numerous brokers target vulnerable populations as supply of organ transplants, it is necessary to build a social safety net. To accomplish this, member states may consider policy frameworks that provide targeted economic support to impoverished communities. This approach aims to reduce tragic situations in which people are forced to sell their organs due to financial hardship. However, limitations with budget will exist in developing nations.

Furthermore, recent organ trafficking brokers recruit donors through dark web or Social Network Services(SNS) such as Facebook and Telegram. By establishing international norms, for example, regulating those websites, member states could help crack down on brokers and, as a result, disrupt the supply of illegal organ trafficking.

Building Public Awareness and Prevention Education

To effectively eradicate organ trafficking, not only law enforcement is needed, but also comprehensive education is an essential factor. As vulnerable populations are mostly targeted by illicit networks, the government can consider education programs as prevention to prevent crime victimization. Furthermore, awareness programs must be integrated into public institutions, including universities and schools, to educate the public on the severity of illegal organ trafficking and the ethical boundaries of transplantation.

Regulating Transplant Tourism and Expanding Legal Donation

To curb transplant tourism driven by the severe shortage of legally donated organs, governments can also consider policy options. For instance, a reporting framework could allow citizens who undergo transplant surgeries abroad to register upon their return. Restricting insurance coverage for unverified foreign transplants may deter demand but raises ethical concerns about patient welfare and post-operative care. Additionally, by implementing a donor registration system, governments can empower citizens to make voluntary decisions regarding donation of organs. Therefore, this aims to greatly increase the supply of legal organs and diminish the necessity of the black markets.

Enhancing International Cooperation

Cooperating with international organizations such as Interpol enables nations to effectively access shared information and dismantle criminal networks more efficiently. This simplifies the extradition process, ensuring that illicit brokers cannot evade punishment by crossing borders. Additionally, nations can make use of shared technological capabilities to track criminals. By mapping the entire process of the supply chain, nations can thoroughly track and disrupt organized criminal syndicates.

Major parties involved

United States of America

The United States of America plays a vital role in eradicating illegal organ trafficking networks. Due to severe domestic donor shortages, American patients often drive significant demand in the global black market through transplant tourism. On the other hand, the U.S. provides financial information capabilities that block illegal money laundering and funds INTERPOL joint operations such as Operation Liberterra. Moreover, through existing frameworks like the Trafficking Victims Protection Act(TVPA) and the State Department's annual Trafficking in Persons(TIP) Report, the United States enforces sanctions. To complement these general frameworks, the United States has been pursuing strict legislation such as the Stop Forced Organ Harvesting Act to dismantle these illicit networks. Furthermore, through structural reforms within Organ Procurement and Transplantation Network(OPTN), the U.S. is making an effort to boost ethical domestic donations, consequently systematically diminishing its reliance on foreign black markets. Thus, the United States is likely to focus on strengthening cross-border financial tracking, sanctions, and law enforcement operations to dismantle illicit networks while pursuing domestic procurement reform to reduce reliance on foreign black markets.

People's Republic of China

China remains at the center of intense international debate regarding illicit organ networks. On the one hand, international human rights organizations and UN experts repeatedly raise suspicions of government-led forced organ harvesting, targeting ethnic minorities, including Uyghurs and other Muslim minorities, and prisoners. Furthermore, critics point to unusually short transplant wait times as evidence, indicating China as a primary destination for foreign transplant tourism. However, the Chinese government strongly denies these claims, asserting that it officially banned the harvesting of organs from executed prisoners in 2015. China continues to emphasise its progress in establishing a transparent and voluntary domestic organ donation system, which is called the China Organ Transplant Response System(COTRS), and strictly criminalizing black market transactions under national laws. China would emphasise national sovereignty in healthcare regulation, highlight the national voluntary donation system(COTRS), and resist external intrusive investigations while supporting general anti-trafficking law enforcement cooperation.

Arab Republic of Egypt

Egypt is a major entry point where refugees escaped from conflict zones such as Sudan, Syria, and Somalia. They sell their organs to raise the funds to go to Europe or become involved in the organ trade. Especially vulnerable people from North Africa or the Middle East are easily targeted. Additionally, patients from wealthy countries in the Middle East or Europe cross into Egypt to undergo surgeries, taking advantage of its active black markets, due to lower costs and relative accessibility. In the process, several corrupt doctors, nurses, private hospitals, and brokers have been caught colluding to perform illegal surgeries. In 2010, the Egyptian government realized the problem and established Law No.5, which strictly prohibits organ trafficking. In 2017, it strengthened the punishment so that if a donor died during an illicit organ transplantation, courts were able to sentence medical professionals to life imprisonment or capital punishment. Egypt shows a strong commitment to law enforcement by eradicating large illegal organ trafficking organizations, including doctors and brokers, cooperating with UNODC and INTERPOL. Egypt would greatly advocate for international financial and technical assistance to strengthen border controls and medical oversight, while supporting harsh criminal penalties for transnational brokers.

Kingdom of Spain

Spain is a global standard that possesses the excellent framework of organ donation in the world and enforces strict criminal law responses about illicit organ trafficking. Spain recorded approximately 40 to 50 donors per million population, allowing it to rank first in the world in organ donation rates for decades. Generally, all citizens are potential organ donors unless they opt out of organ donation. Moreover, Spain has transplant coordinators in each hospital, so that they meticulously procure organs from brain-dead patients with instant consultation with family members. Additionally, Spain imposes harsh punishment on brokers, doctors, and transplanted patients who bought an illegal organ. Therefore, as Spain has affluent legal organ supplies, citizens do not have to turn to black markets or transplant tourism. Spain will promote global adoption of national donor self-sufficiency models as the fundamental long-term solution to eliminate demand for organ trafficking.

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Islamic Republic of Iran

Iran is the only country that has legalised a government-regulated system for living kidney sales, exclusively restricting commercial transactions to kidney in 1988. In the 1980s, Iran suffered from wars and economic hardship, facing a severe shortage of organ donors, leading to establishment of the law. This framework prohibits private brokers from arranging transactions between patients and donors. Instead, charity and national organ transplant associations designated by the government facilitate kidney donation, supporting donors' compensation and health insurance benefits. However, due to rapid inflation and the economic crisis of Iran, the compensation has lost value. Thus, donors, especially poor youth, and patients trade illegally, appearing in gray markets. Iran would claim that there should be a clear distinction between legal and monitored commercial donations and illegal organ trafficking.

Federal Democratic Republic of Nepal

Nepal is one of the countries where organ trafficking is severe in the world. For instance, regions such as Hokse, near Kathmandu, have gained international notoriety as "Kidney Villages", as impoverished populations were deceived by brokers into selling their kidneys under the false promise of organ regeneration and financial security. Furthermore, because of the lack of advanced infrastructure or organ transplantation in Nepal, illicit brokers traffic Nepali donors to India, forging documents to pass the medical screening. The situation deteriorated in 2015 due to a major earthquake, leaving vulnerable displaced populations exposed to organ trafficking brokers. Therefore, Nepal is likely to call for international aid to build social safety nets and medical infrastructure, while emphasising the importance of regional intelligence-sharing to prevent cross-border trafficking of vulnerable populations.

International Criminal Police Organization(INTERPOL)

INTERPOL is an organization that eradicates highly sophisticated black market criminal networks and serves as the central operational framework for international law enforcement. INTERPOL coordinates operations, most notably Operation Liberterra, which brings together law enforcement agencies across multiple continents to dismantle illicit networks, arrest brokers, and rescue vulnerable victims. It issues INTERPOL Red Notices to fugitive traffickers and Purple Notices to seek or provide information on the methods used by criminals. Additionally, by utilizing

INTERPOL's Financial Crime and Anti-Corruption Centre(IFCACC), it tracks funding sources of illicit organ trafficking networks and helps freeze their funds, cooperating with international police to disrupt the supply chain of illegal organ trade.

Timeline Of Events

Date	Description of Event
First endeavor of transplant surgery between pig and human, 1838	Doctors made an early attempt to transfer the cornea of a pig to a human.
Successful kidney transplantation to human, 1954	Doctor Joseph E. Murray carried out a transplant between identical twins.
The introduction of cyclosporine, 1980s	This medication prevented the body from rejecting transplanted organs, resulting in success of surgeries.
Iran established a government-regulated system for living kidney sales, 1988	The kidney is the only organ allowed for commercial transactions..
Protocol to Prevent, Suppress and Punish Trafficking in Persons, Especially Women and Children(Palermo Protocol) entered into force, which is the first agreement that clarifies legal definition of the removal of organs, December 25th, 2003(effective date)	It indicated that if brokers abuse vulnerabilities of victims, it is regulated as a crime regardless of consent of victims.
The Declaration of Istanbul(Non-UN bioethical framework) was enacted by medical professionals, May 2008	It established frameworks about ethical organ donation and strictly prohibited transplant tourism and transplant commercialism.
The Council of Europe Convention(Regional non-UN treaty) against Trafficking in Human Organs was entered into force, March 1st, 2018(effective date)	This convention requires nations to establish standards of organ removal and transplantation to prevent organ trafficking and strengthen international investigation and victim protection.
Operation Liberterra II was implemented by INTERPOL, which was carried out across 116 countries, 2024	This operation tackled TIP for OR and migrant smuggling, which are severe forms of exploitation.
Operation Liberterra III was an international	Similar to Operation Liberterra II, it managed to

operation that was led by INTERPOL and cooperated with UNODC, 2025	crack down on TIP for OR. During this operation, numerous suspects of human trafficking were arrested.

UN Involvement, Resolutions, Treaties and Events

- WHO Guiding Principles on Human Cell, Tissue and Organ Transplantation, endorsed via Resolution WHA63.22, 2010

This guideline indicated ethical frameworks about cell, tissue, and organ transplantation. Donations should be voluntary, rather than forced and also donors should give consent after receiving sufficient information. Moreover, human organs and tissues must not be bought or sold as commodities, nor should donors be recruited for financial gain. Vulnerable groups and economically disadvantaged individuals should be protected from being exploited for organ trafficking. Additionally, the transplantation system should be operated transparently to easily track the source and movement of organs and protect the rights of recipients and donors regarding national laws and medical policies.

- The Declaration of Istanbul on Organ Trafficking and Transplant Tourism, 2008

The Declaration of Istanbul was adopted by The Transplantation Society(TTS), the International Society of Nephrology (ISN), and more than 150 medical professionals, serving as a framework to eradicate unethical conduct. Specifically, it strictly prohibits organ trafficking, transplant tourism, and commercial organ trade, which exploit vulnerable groups. In particular, it urged nations to establish donor self-sufficiency through a transparent and clear donation system to meet demand.

- UNODC and partners developed a toolkit for investigation and prosecution to solve the problem of underreported or undetected TIP for OR in 2022. Specifically, it indicated how law enforcement agencies and medical professionals identify signs of illegal organ transplantation and gather relevant evidence, the process to identify and protect victims, and information sharing and cooperation between countries. It also included virtual reality based training tools that recreated medical settings, such as hospitals and operating rooms, to improve practitioners' ability to investigate crime scenes. Through this toolkit, UNODC aims to detect trafficking for organ removal earlier, ensure effective prosecution of criminals, and strengthen the protection of victims.

- Council of Europe Convention against Trafficking in Human Organs, 2018

This international convention, a regional legally binding treaty independent of the United Nations, was established to prevent organ trafficking and illicit organ removal. To be specific, it guarantees voluntary consent of organ donors and calls upon nations to criminalize organ removal without consent and organ removal conducted outside legal transplantation systems. Furthermore, it includes strengthening victim protection and international investigation, and judicial cooperation, and operating a legal and transparent organ donation system.

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